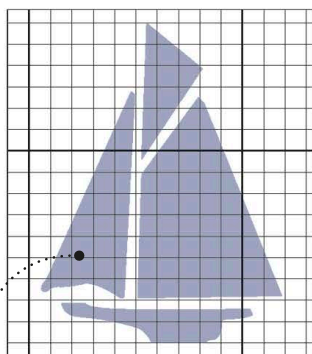


▶▶ ALTERING THE SIZE OF A MOTIF

The easiest way to alter the size of a motif is to use a photocopier. Whether enlarging or reducing, divide your desired size by the actual size of the template.

1 For non-geometric motifs, trace the outline onto gridded paper. To make a pattern twice the size of the original, draw a grid double the size on another piece of paper. If you start with 1.2cm ($\frac{1}{2}$ in) squares, for example, increase the size of each square in your new grid to 2.5cm (1in).

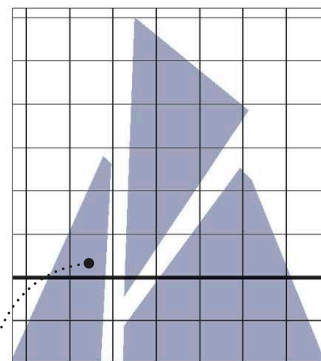
The original motif traced onto paper gridded into 1.2cm ($\frac{1}{2}$ in) squares.



Multiply that figure by 100 to give the percentage of the enlargement or reduction you will need. You can also use gridded paper to alter the size of a motif, as below.

2 Transfer the lines within each square of the grid so they correspond to the lines of the original motif. When you have finished, trace the motif onto a new piece of paper to smooth out any distortions. You are now ready to transfer the newly sized motif to a template.

The motif enlarged onto a 2.5cm (1in) grid.

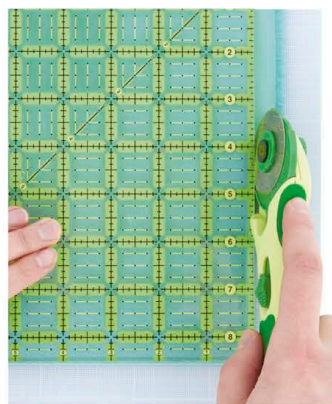


▶▶ ROTARY CUTTING

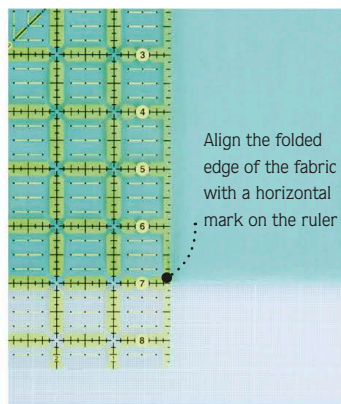
Many of the most popular patterns can be rotary cut. You will need a rotary cutter, a quilter's ruler, and a self-healing mat. When cutting a square into other shapes, such as half-square triangles that will be

reassembled into a square, you must start with a square that is larger than your finished square will be, to allow for the seam allowances. Always keep your fingers away from the cutting edge.

CUTTING A STRIP



1 First you must straighten the edge of the fabric. Fold the washed and pressed fabric so the selvages are together. Place it on the mat, with the folded edge aligned with the top of the ruler. Lay the ruler on top and cut along the edge of the ruler, away from your body, to remove the selvages. Keep the hand holding the ruler steady.



Align the folded edge of the fabric with a horizontal mark on the ruler

2 Turn the mat so as not to disturb the newly cut edge and reposition the ruler over the area of fabric that is to be your strip. Align the ruler carefully along the cut edge to give the desired width and line up the folded edge with a horizontal mark on the quilter's ruler. Cut the fabric strip along the grain.